

OREGON CITY COURIER

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"NOW IS THE TIME"

January the first will soon be with us. January first is that peculiar day when we all make more or less resolutions, and when we get mad when we date letters "1916" instead of "1915." This year it will also be the day when we will bravely and boldly take a drink of beer or booze, just to show that we don't care even if the state has gone dry. In fact it is a safe bet to make, right now, that more beer, wine and liquor will be consumed on the first of January than was drunk in any day in 1915 in Oregon. For it is human nature to show one's independence; and lots of people, many of whom voted for the "dry" law, will take a drink on New Year's just to show that their personal liberty has not been one whit curtailed. And after taking that drink as a sign of individual independence, people will settle down to the new order of things and obey the law—as the majority always does.

January first will also find the Northwest waking up to a new era of prosperity—an era that bids fair to outrank all former periods of "good times" as far as development and progress go. With the lumber barons planning an outlay of many hundreds of thousands in this section to open up and develop new timber holdings, the Northwest is bound to be prosperous; for the lumber resources of the Pacific Slope are the backbone and ribs of this section's wealth. And not only will the new development of these vast timber holdings directly bring a new prosperity to this Farthest West, but the very development work itself is a forecast of better times to come—for the timber barons would not dump their capital into new logging roads and new logging camps did they not foresee a coming need of new building and structural material.

The outlook is that the Northwest will rebuild the Old World in this year of 1916. It appears from many sources that the conflict that is draining Europe of its men and that is piling up ruin, grief and sorrow, cannot much longer continue. And as soon as the great war stops, there will be a cry for material with which to rebuild the stricken cities. And much of that material will come from the virgin forests of the Northwest, where great stands of fir have been waiting through centuries for the call of man. In our possessions of fir we have the most wonderful of woods; a timber from which can be fashioned everything from heavy joists to the thinnest of veneers, and the grain of which can be so cut and stained as to imitate every other kind of wood that there is. Into our treasury of fir there will be sent thousands of men, and from the work which they do will spread prosperity in every line.

Nineteen sixteen bids also to be a lively year in other ways. Not only will the approaching end of the war stimulate the manufacturing arts; but the return of the Old World to sanity will also stimulate the finer phases of man's nature. In addition to that the lessons that the war has taught this country will bear fruit—and the supplies which we have learned to manufacture ourselves, instead of importing from abroad, will call for the erection of many new factories and other plants. And then we will have, in Oregon, a lively political season; and everybody knows that Oregon is happiest and wealthiest when engaged in the gentle pastime of selecting its best (?) men to fill public office.

With this outlook before us, the Courier wants to wish everybody a happy and prosperous New Year, and hopes that the desires of all will be fulfilled at least in part during the next 360 or so days. And, since we have so much prosperity ahead of us, and since the outlook is so good at this time for a year of plenty—wouldn't it be a good plan right now to start putting away a nickel or so every day, so that next year we can all of us buy the sort of Christmas presents that we will want to give at the end of a prosperous year?

ON THE SQUARE

Estacada citizens who are planning to invoke the referendum on its

proposed purchase of the county fair grounds at Canby should have no great difficulty in getting signers to their petition. The expenditure of \$7,950 for the purchase of a county fair grounds is a matter that concerns every taxpayer in the county, and it is not a matter to be settled at a so-called "taxpayers' meeting," when in a minute of enthusiasm the scheme was given endorsement. Seven thousand nine hundred and fifty dollars is a lot of money, when it has to be raised by taxation; and the people who will contribute this money should have very much to say about the way it is to be spent.

While Estacada's protest against the purchase of the Canby fair grounds may be caused by community jealousy, in this case Estacada and the entire northern section of the county has every right to be jealous. It has a right to be even more than jealous, and no fair-minded citizen will object to signing the petitions to place the question of the Canby purchase on the ballot. The present fair grounds at Canby may be worth the sum asked; but that is no reason why they should be purchased by the county. It is not the place of the county to make realty investments.

The chief purpose of a county fair is to display the things the county can produce. And this display ought to be made in the most accessible place in the county. The site should be not only accessible, to the residents of the county, but to people from outside—and the Canby site is served by only one railroad. In addition to this it is a long way from the northern section of the county; a long way by train and road, and an inconvenient distance, too. It ought to be easy to use \$7,950 to better advantage than by buying the old fair grounds at Canby; and if this sum must be used for the purchase of a display spot, the place ought to be selected with a view to its accessibility to every portion of the county and to Portland—for the county is just as anxious to have Portland people and tourists see its fair as it is to have its own people see it.

The Courier has no spot in view for the fair grounds. It is not boosting for any special locality. But it seems to the Courier that any county fair, to be a success, should be located on a tract of land lying somewhere in the angle formed by the Estacada and Oregon City interurban lines; for this angle is not only traversed by the main line of the Southern Pacific, but it is also cut by the fast-growing Carver line, and is just as accessible to folk who live along the line of the Willamette Valley Southern. If the fair grounds were located somewhere within a radius of three miles of Milwaukie, say, all sections of the county would receive an equal share of transportation conveniences, and the fair would also be near enough to Portland to draw a heavy attendance of outside visitors. And in the final run, it is the outsiders who will be impressed by the display of the county's resources who will do the most good to the county—for they will be moved to invest in the section that yields the rich production shown.

The Courier does not believe that the county ought to purchase the present fair grounds at Canby. It believes that these grounds ought to be abandoned as the site of the county's annual display of its resources, and that some other and more centrally located site should be selected. Then there will be time enough to talk about county ownership.

WHERE IT PAYS

Government statistics show that on an average the person who stops his or her education at the end of grammar school earns \$250 per year. Those who continue through high school average about a thousand dollars a year in salary; and those who take four years additional training in a technical school or university average annual incomes of \$2,000 and over per year. Hence it would seem that it pays to keep the boy or girl in school as long as is possible.

Of course there are exceptions to

these averages. Edison, who didn't have much of a school education, has an income now that is dizzying to contemplate. But Edison studied outside of school more than many a university graduate ever studied in his whole life. And in the other direction, there are college graduates who are driving horsecars for a dollar and a half a day.

It stands to reason, however, that the more the mind is trained in youth, the greater will be its success in grappling with the problems of later life, and the greater advantage will that mind have in earning a comfortable living for the body over which it rules. Hence it is the duty of every parent or guardian of a youngster to keep that youngster in school just as long as the youngster will stay. There is no sense in driving a boy or girl to the higher institutions of learning if the boy or girl really doesn't want to go, or hasn't the mental alertness sufficient to absorb the training given. But the average child, in good health, will develop sufficiently as it grows to get the full benefit of all the education that can be furnished; and it is the duty of the parents to see that the child has this advantage.

We are reminded by the government statistics quoted at the beginning of this spasm of a man in Massachusetts, who called his boy to him the day after he graduated from college, and showed him an itemized account of the money that had been expended on "raising" him. The total was close to \$25,000. Said the man:

"Son, I have invested in you an average of a thousand dollars a year. Now it is up to you to pay dividends on that. I don't begrudge the money, but I want you to regard yourself at least as much as you would a piece of machinery that cost \$25,000; and I

is that the small towns have too many business houses. They are paying rent, taxes and insurance on too much for the amount of business they do.

"If Woodburn had one implement house and about two good general merchandise stores, you would have no reason to 'holler' mail order house, for then they could meet prices that are impossible for them now and yet they would make dollars where they now make cents. Six or eight years ago Woodburn could support more stores than she can today, by about twice as many, because the Oregon Electric on the west has cut off trade and the Willamette Valley Southern has cut off trade on the east.

"I have never found Woodburn a good trading point for the reason that every resident has a small farm where they raise their own potatoes, fruit and garden vegetables, and some of them have a cow or two. Not quite all of them grow apples, but for those that do not, I see that your merchants have a good supply of Hood River apples. Yet they say, 'Spend your money at home.' I say, 'Let the town practice what it preaches.' If they did you would all be buying wood from the farmers instead of buying Washington coal. Your mills have discarded their steam engines and put in electric motors because they had to spend a few dollars with the farmers for wood. I think it is time that Woodburn should start spending its own money at home."

The Courier has heard similar comments from some of the farmers who live near Oregon City, and it has printed a few letters from them, too. It prints this Woodburn letter here to add to the general store of information on the subject, and also because it may possibly contain some hints that will be helpful to Oregon City boosters

ing car on the interurban to bring its full quota of packages—round packages done up in the familiar box form, and which leaked when shaken.

If everybody in Oregon City didn't get all the booze they wanted with which to stock up for the "dry spell," it wasn't the fault of the city administration, for not a hand was raised to stop the steady influx of packages of bargain wet goods. Knowing how ardent the police usually are in enforcing the law, it can only be concluded that the "higher ups" must have passed the word to be blind; for practically nobody was molested or compelled to use the express companies to bring in their liquid joy.

Hence banish forever the charge that the administration was narrow, hide-bound, Puritanical and strict. Let history proclaim the truth, and let it be known to all that never was a greater "liberalism" shown, and that never before was the law so universally winked at. And let there be praise for those who thus demonstrated an unsuspected liberal side of their make-up; for it ought to be known that the milk of human kindness runs in some veins. For the last two weeks of the year the famous Jones anti-booze law, which was drawn by the "city attorney" was the dearest "dead letter" ever known in these parts. And so does the administration stand revealed as kindly to the erring—more kind than ever would have been suspected.

CHANCE FOR ECONOMY

The Hubbard Enterprise last week remarked that it didn't see much use in post masters. It finds that the post master in a small office eats up most of the profits, and thinks that the

A Prosperous 1916

May Father Time deal kindly with you and yours during the new year.

May he bring brightness into your home and may his foot prints be upon the right side of your bank book

May he often incline your feet in our direction and may your business be of such a nature that when the new year has grown old we will both look back and say "A very good year indeed."

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want you to know that I expect at least as much of you as I would of such a piece of machinery. I should hate to think that all that money was just thrown away."

Whether this little homily had its effect on the boy or not we do not know—but the boy is now head of a transportation company, and is paid \$18,000 a year for the manner in which he conducts the business. And \$18,000 a year is a pretty good dividend on an investment of \$25,000. It would appear that in this case education paid—and it will be found that in most cases an education pays.

THE OTHER SIDE

Oregon City is not the only community that has been conducting a "buy-it-at-home" campaign. Woodburn has also been through the throes of trying to keep its money in circulation at home, and has elaborated the farmer for dealing with the mail-order house. And a farmer writes to the Woodburn Independent about it, and gives his side of the case, saying in part:

"You say the home merchant is on the square, because he has to be to make good, and if he sells you anything that is not as represented, you can return the goods. All very true, but do you suppose that if all these mail order houses had not sold their goods just as represented, that they would be enjoying the prosperity they are today. The size of the whole thing

who want to see Clackamas county patronize its own resources.

"Buy-it-at-home" is a fine idea, it is the best idea that there is—but to be a success, EVERYBODY must do it.

TRUE LIBERALITY

Carping critics have accused some of our city officials, including our "city attorney," of being narrow minded, and of being almost Puritanical in their enforcement of laws to the letter. Never was a charge more unfounded, and never was so great an injustice done. And while this may be a late hour in which to acknowledge it, the Courier would rather be "better late than never."

Anybody who has in the past accused the members of the outgoing city administration of being narrow minded, of being martinets in discipline and of being ultra-strict in the enforcement of law, certainly could not have looked about much during the past two weeks. For never was greater leniency given a wayward populace.

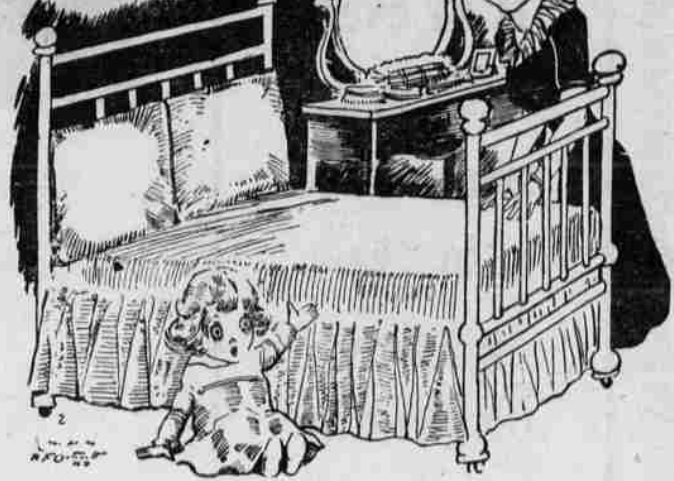
With the state going "dry" the first of the year, and with Portland liquor houses selling all sorts of wet stuff at rock-bottom prices, it would have been indeed cruel for the city administration to have enforced the "dry" laws which stand upon its statute books. It showed their true liberalism that they did not enforce them, and that they permitted each incom-

official with the decorative title and the official pull might just as well be dispensed with. The idea seems a good one, and other great men aside from the editor of the Hubbard Enterprise, have approved of it. Among them is William Howard Taft, about whose ideas on the subject the Polk County Observer editorializes as follows:

"Ex-President Taft says the government could save at least \$4,000,000 a year by simply abolishing postmasters and conducting the postal department on the same basis that private business is conducted. He suggests that deputy postmasters, selected for ability and efficiency and named under civil service regulations, could and should be the real executives in each postoffice, and further declares that this would put an end to 'interminable politics and actual waste' which now permeate the postal system and handicaps it in rendering service to the public. Moreover he believes it is not fair or right to 'devil' the president with factional fuses, bickerings and strife that always accompany the selection of each new postmaster. The whole system is wrong, wasteful and needlessly disturbing, in his opinion, and he thinks the time has come to look for a better system, based on sound business rules and regulations.

The suggestion is really a good one and should be carefully and earnestly considered by the people of this country, who can easily bring this change

Rest easy in a new comfortable bed.



Dear Amy:-

I feel so refreshed this morning that I'll pay you the letter I owe you. I just haven't felt like writing for a long time, but yesterday my new furniture came and I fixed up my bedroom. My, how I slept!

It makes you feel so much more cheerful and happy to wake up in a beautifully furnished bedroom.

You want to be careful though when you buy your furniture. While you are at it, get the good kind that will last, like I did.

As ever

Lou.

P.S.—I'm delighted with my new furniture. I bought it from

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Oregon City, Ore.

about by simply giving it their approval. There is not a particle of doubt that efficiency, economy and better service would be promoted by discontinuing the practice of rewarding political workers by giving them jobs and salaries as postmasters and no other reason to continue this practice than that it "suits the politicians" and offers an incentive to play the game.

When, however, the people get the worst of it in the long run, in wastefulness, inefficiency and deterioration of service, why should the public hesitate to throw this slovenly and loose system into the discard and insist on the substitution of a better system, based on real business rules? And in thinking it over they should remember that Mr. Taft says this would result in an annual saving of at least \$4,000,000 while the chances are the economies which would follow would greatly exceed even that estimated amount.

WRONG, BROTHER

Portland is an inland town whose leading and influential citizens are conservatives. They seek to bring that city back to its former state with a little additional glory. Their intentions are good enough though their methods are peculiar and ancient. It might be a good thing if their leading, influential and conservative citizens gained further and necessary knowledge and modern ideas. They could send a dependable and broad-minded committee to Tacoma, Seattle and San Francisco to "do a little learning."

Say not so, brother. No committee of Portlanders could learn anything from Tacoma, Seattle or San Francisco. Portlanders are so cock-sure, so positive of their own superiority, and so contented with their own ways, that even Jehova Himself couldn't teach them anything. Portland, in its own estimation, solved the riddle of the universe forty or more years ago; and ever since that time Portland has been living according to the precepts set down in the first issue of the Oregonian. Portland is the one thing on earth that will never change, never advance and never admit that it might be wrong.

Happy New Year, everybody!

Two more days and the lid goes on all over Oregon.

"The dying year is on his final pier" sings the poet. Yes, and in Oregon he's on his final beer, too.

A combined thunder storm and blizzard hit the East Sunday. Out

here in Oregon we only get one of 'em at a time.

Convict in Idaho distributed his prison earnings as Christmas presents to his creditors outside. Verily, an honest man.

If Christmas was any criterion, the closing year has been a prosperous one. Postal employees and express men all report a record business.

If T. Roosevelt is as "politically dead" as some of us would like to believe, why are the republicans so anxious to get a "standard bearer" who will be acceptable to Roosevelt?

Relief supplies sent to Serbia are being sold in Serbian stores, it is said. This is not the first time in history that graft has spoiled charity. There was San Francisco.

Seven Oregon lads have won prizes for corn in a nation-wide show at St. Paul. They used to say that corn only grew in dry climates—but then, Oregon isn't so wet as some people think.

The Oregonian gives a review of the resources of the Yakima country, "leaving fruit statistics out of consideration." What's the matter? Doesn't the Oregonian care to admit the superiority of Yakima apples?

It is still to be noted that the prohibitionists have not yet advanced any substitute for the saloon. During the campaign they promised that they were going to produce it as soon as the state went dry.

Another sign of "democratic prosperity" is to be found in the government report which says that silk hosiery is being more generally worn than ever before. Apparently men are "putting money in the wife's stocking."

MRS. KERNS' ADVICE

To Weak, Nervous, Run-Down Women

So, Cumberland, Md.—"For a long time I suffered from a nervous breakdown. I could not eat or sleep and was so weak I could hardly walk. My husband heard about Vinol and got me to try it. Now I have a good appetite, sleep soundly and am well and strong. Every nervous, weak, run-down woman should try Vinol.—Mrs. D. W. KERNS. Vinol is a delicious cod liver and iron tonic, without oil, which we guarantee to create a healthy appetite, aid digestion and make pure healthy blood."

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10:00 A.M.	10:55 A.M.
2:30 P.M.	2:20 P.M.
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The American Express Co. operates over this line.

1881—1916

The growth of a solid, steady reputation cannot be pushed or hurried. The commercial trademarks which have become household expressions were not thrust upon the nation by a "whirlwind campaign" of advertising, but by the constant repetition year by year of claims which were made good to the letter. To win permanent, inseparable friends takes time and testing; it is so with a bank just as with any other business.

Our friends have made us what we are; we believe we have had a hand in making them, too. To retain the old by continued fidelity and devotion, and thus attract the new, is our constant aim.

THE BANK OF OREGON CITY

Oldest Bank in Clackamas County